Spiritual Wonder Project



Crossing Boundaries to Create Engaging Spaces for Critical Thinking, Creative Discovery and Experiential Spiritual Journey, Inside and Outside the Museum

| Project Overview |

Museums around the world today are challenged to raise funds for new projects and technologies that would encourage visitors to return again. The “Spiritual Wonder,” a multi media project, was developed to assist Marianna Kistler Museum of Art, located on the campus of Kansas State University in Manhattan, Kansas to promote a new exhibition titled “Museum of Wonder: A Great Land Grant University Collects” and raise funds for other new projects.

| Project Goals |

Create a unique experience that engages patrons and creates an atmosphere of inquiry, spiritual discovery and joy

Showcase Kansas State University faculty and student talent

Create a memorable and engaging experience for patrons

Connect students with the art and architecture of the museum

Support fundraising at the museum

Involve students in philanthropy and community service

| Project Site |





| Project Site |



http://www.helixkc.com/what-we-do/cultural/

| Project Approach |

Evidence Based Design

Multidisciplinary Collaboration

Community Based Service Learning Pedagogy

| Multidisciplinary Collaboration |

Architecture

Interior Architecture

Product Design

Landscape Architecture

Music

Dance

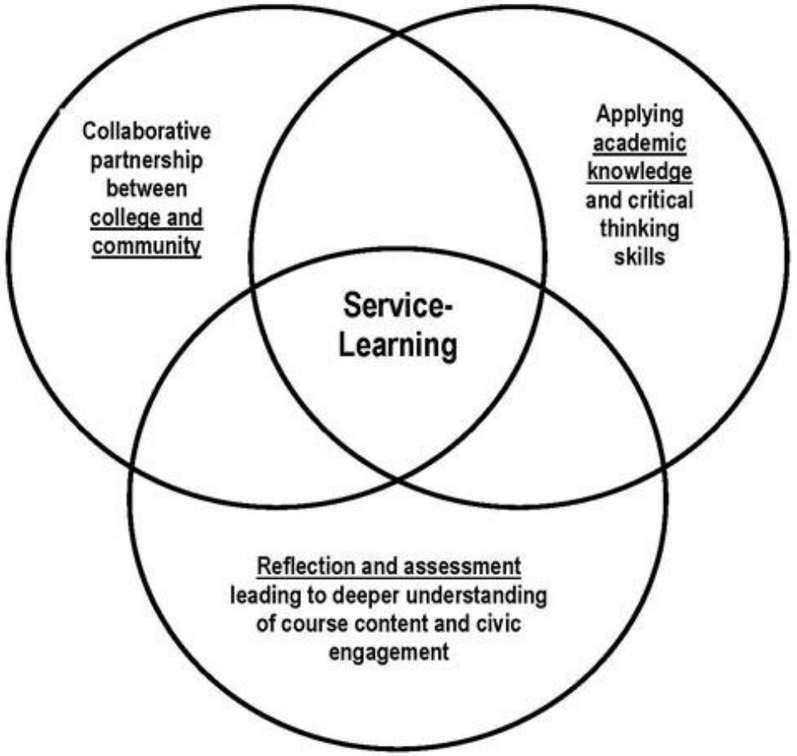
Artists

Curators

Museum Staff



| Community Based Service Learning Pedagogy |



As defined by the International Partnership for Service Learning and Leadership (2008): Service learning is the pedagogy that links academic study with the practical experience of community service.

| Inspiration |



Evans' (1973), interpretation of Cabinets of Curiosities as providers of "solace and retreat for contemplation" became principle "guiding light" for this project. The design team adapted this concept to enhance the connection with nature and designed "retreat like contemplation places" within the gallery and the garden.

| Concept |

Kauffman (1973), described the Holy Roman Emperor Rudolf II, who governed Rome during 1576 – 1612, and his “Kunstammer” as “demonstration of his imperial magnificence and power” and its “symbolic arrangement of their display, ceremoniously presented to visiting diplomats and magnates.”

This description assisted the designers in developing the connection between the museum lobby and the ramp where the symbolic threshold changes were designed to be seen as ceremonious walkway connecting the art within the museum and the natural wonder within the garden.

The idea of connecting the art within the gallery with nature, and how it can provide a “spiritual experience” led the team to consider “Spiritual Wonder” as a title for this project. Thus art became the catalyst for the spiritual journey in this project.

| Research |

Evidence collection through:

Interviews (Director, Museum Staff)

Site observations, analysis and documentation

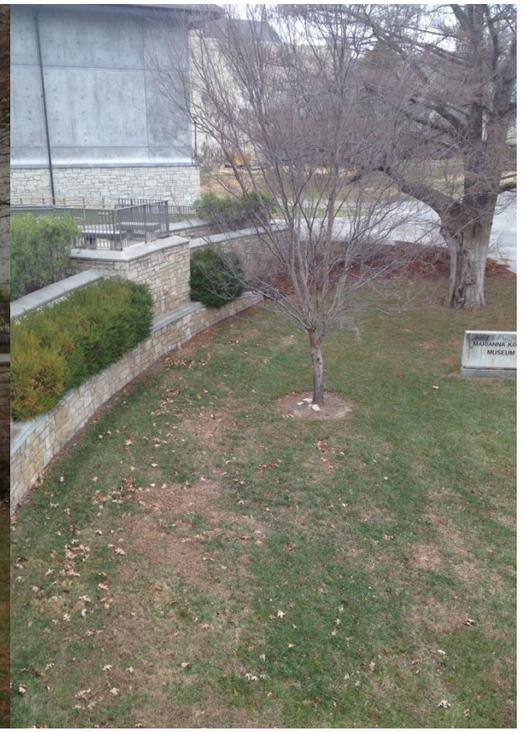
Literature Reviews

Precedent Studies

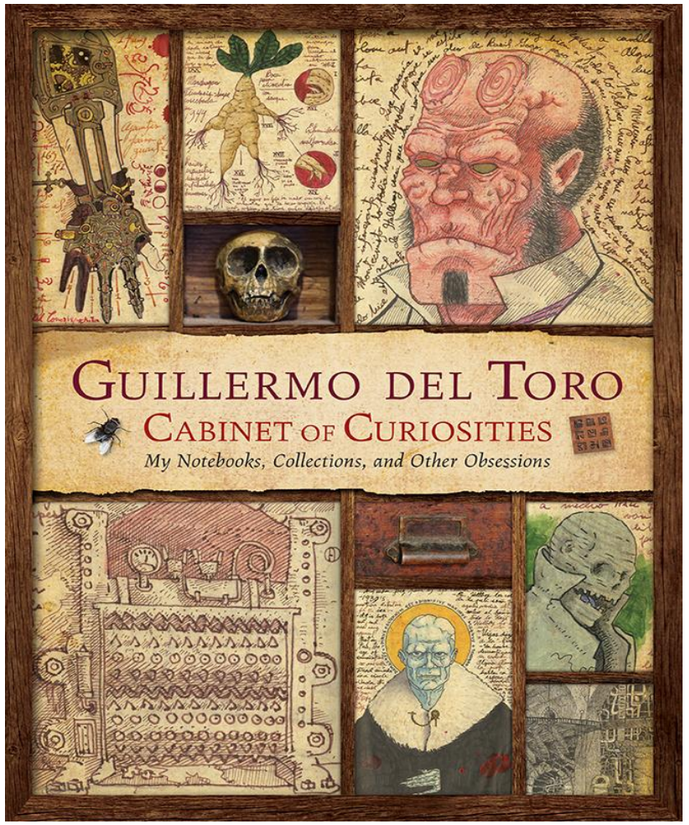
| Site Observations |

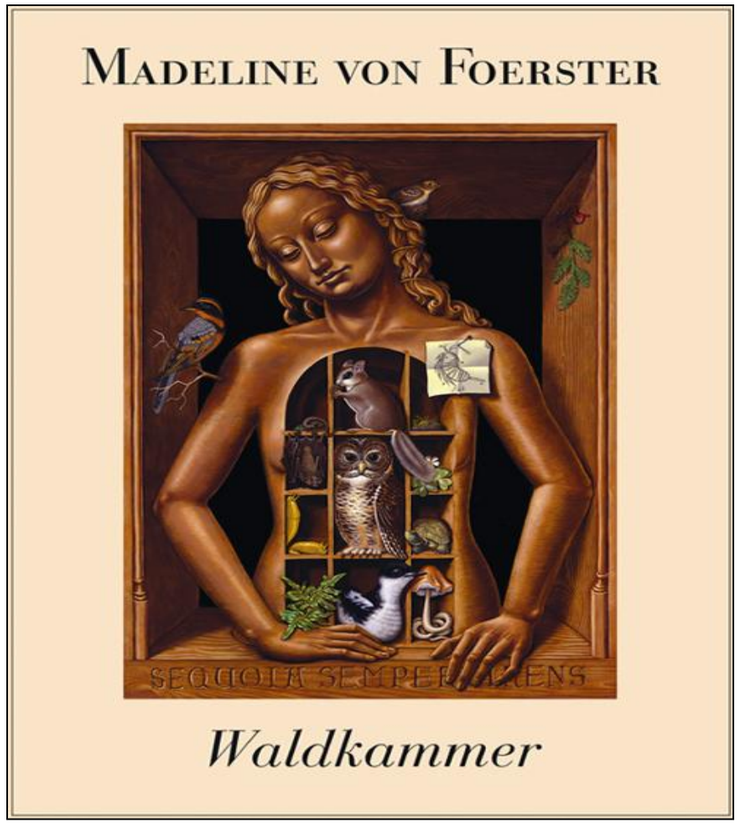


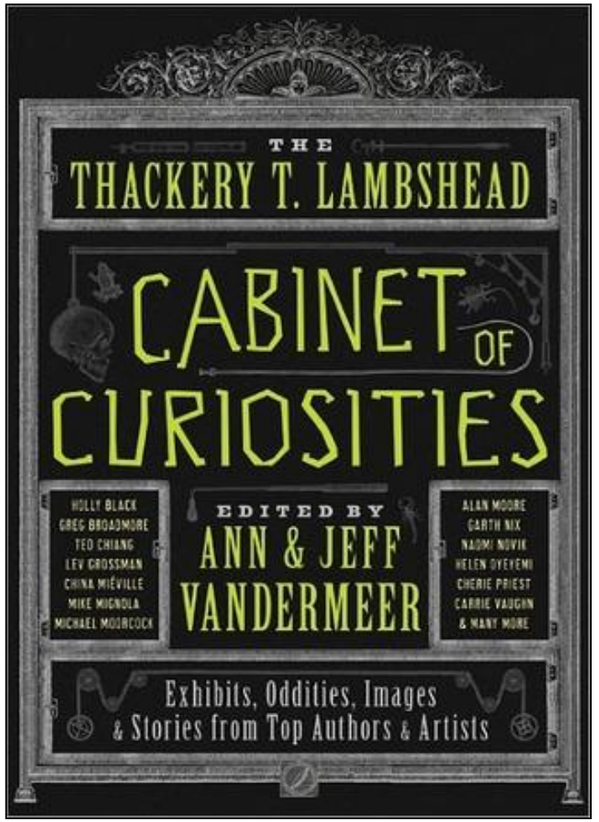




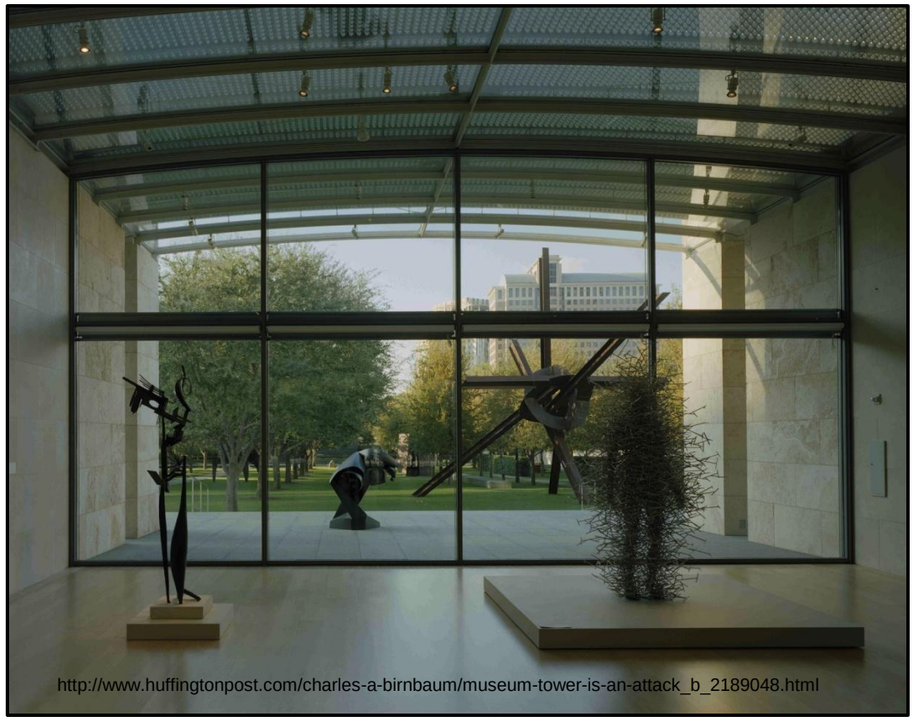
| Literature Reviews |



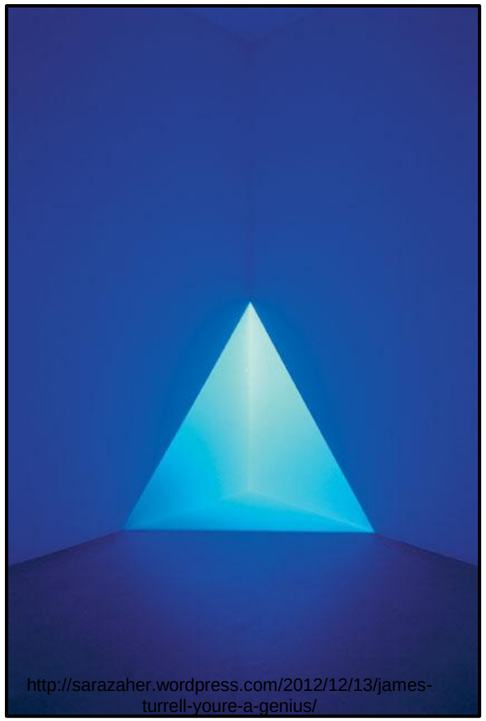




| Precedent Studies |



http://www.huffingtonpost.com/charles-a-birnbaum/museum-tower-is-an-attack_b_2189048.html



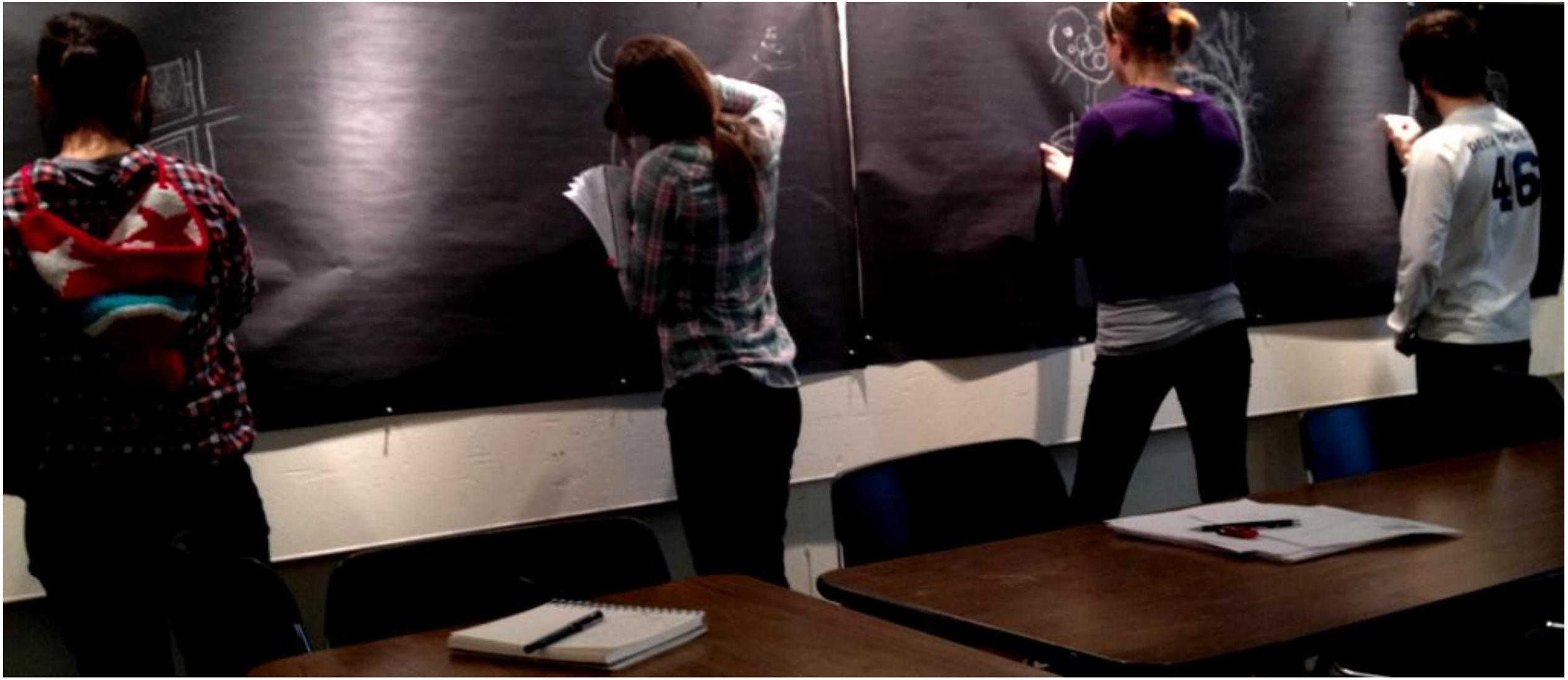
http://sarazaher.wordpress.com/2012/12/13/james-turrell-youre-a-genius/



http://themodern.org/collection/artists/Serra

| Challenges |

Working with Multi Disciplinary Team of Students | Faculty | Museum staff | F of M Committee



| Challenges |

“Seen – Unseen” Aspects | Creating Path – Place Relationship

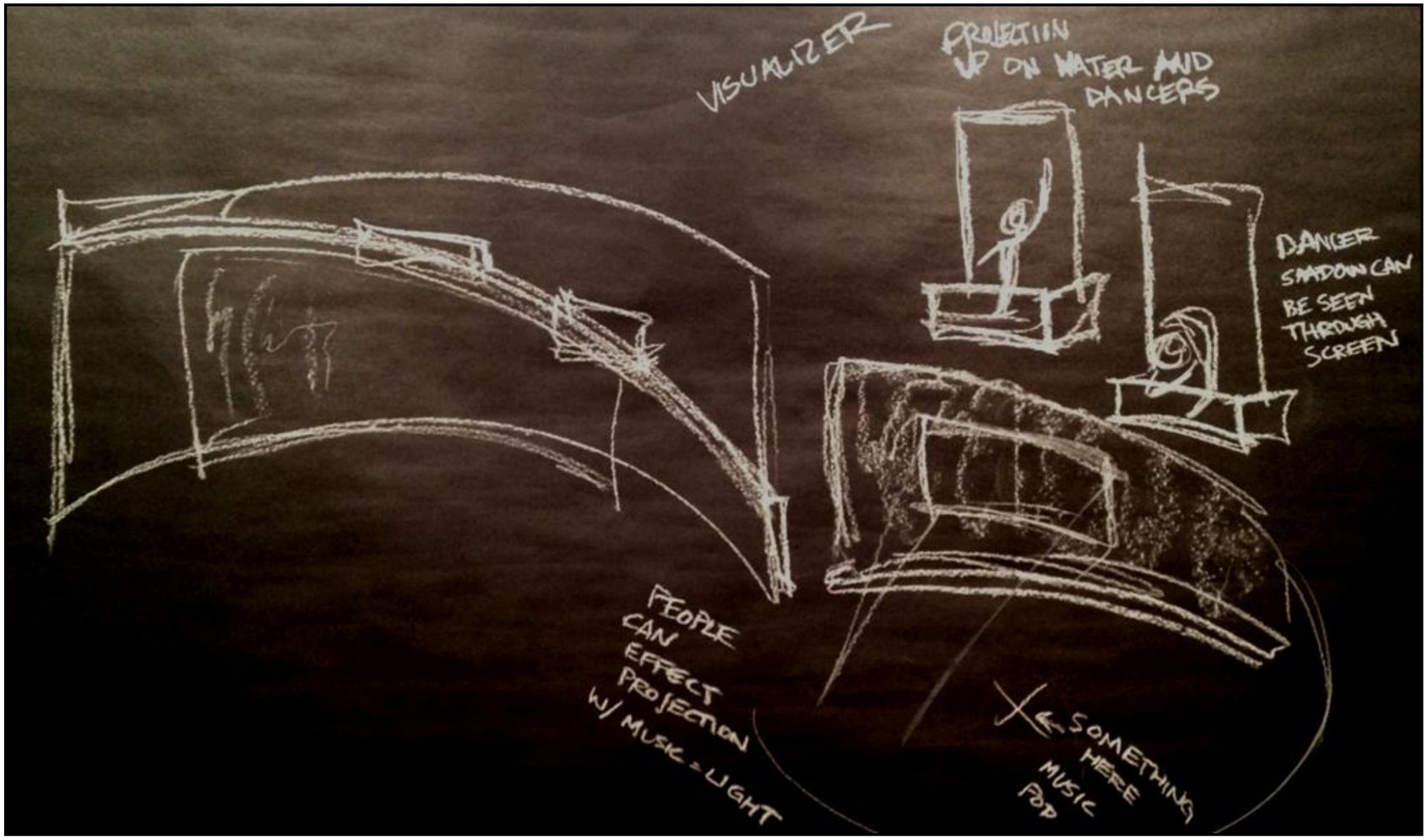




Challenges

Design Process | Creating Path-Place Relationships



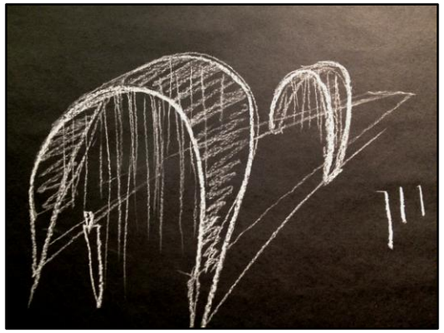


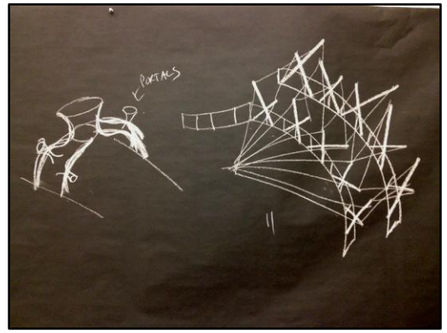
| Challenges |

Design of Threshold Changes | Gateways | Portals



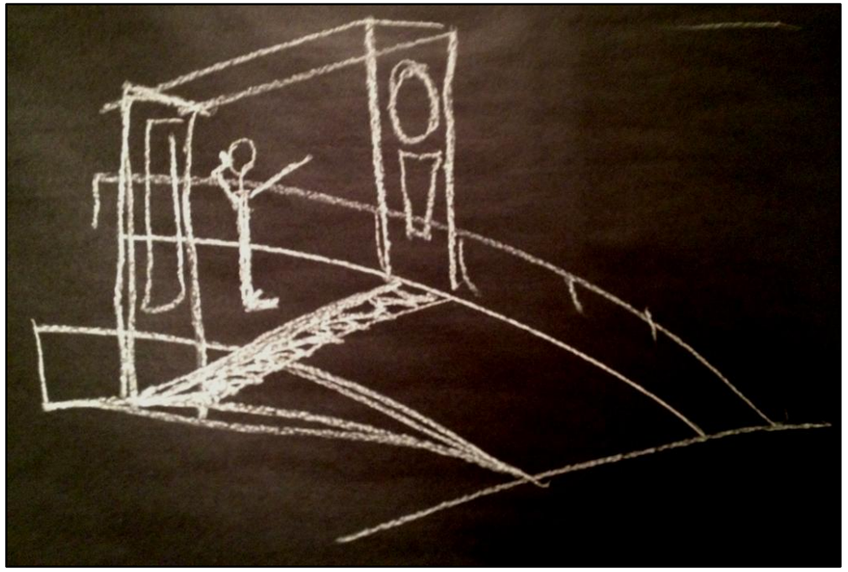


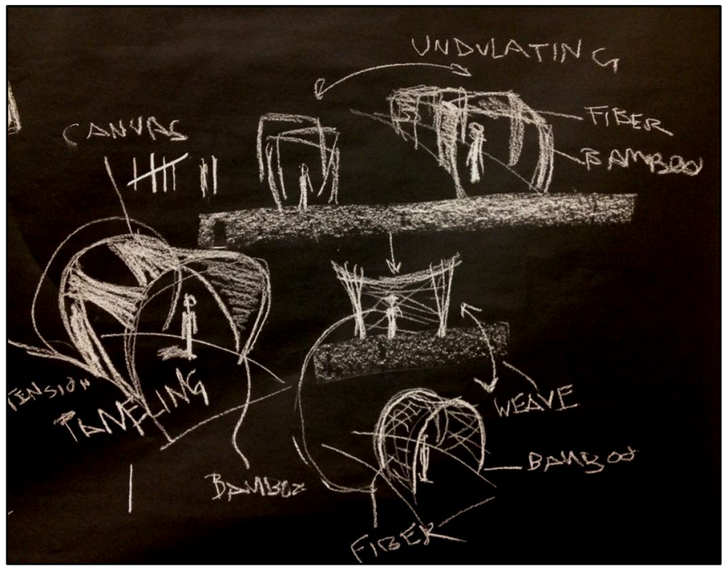






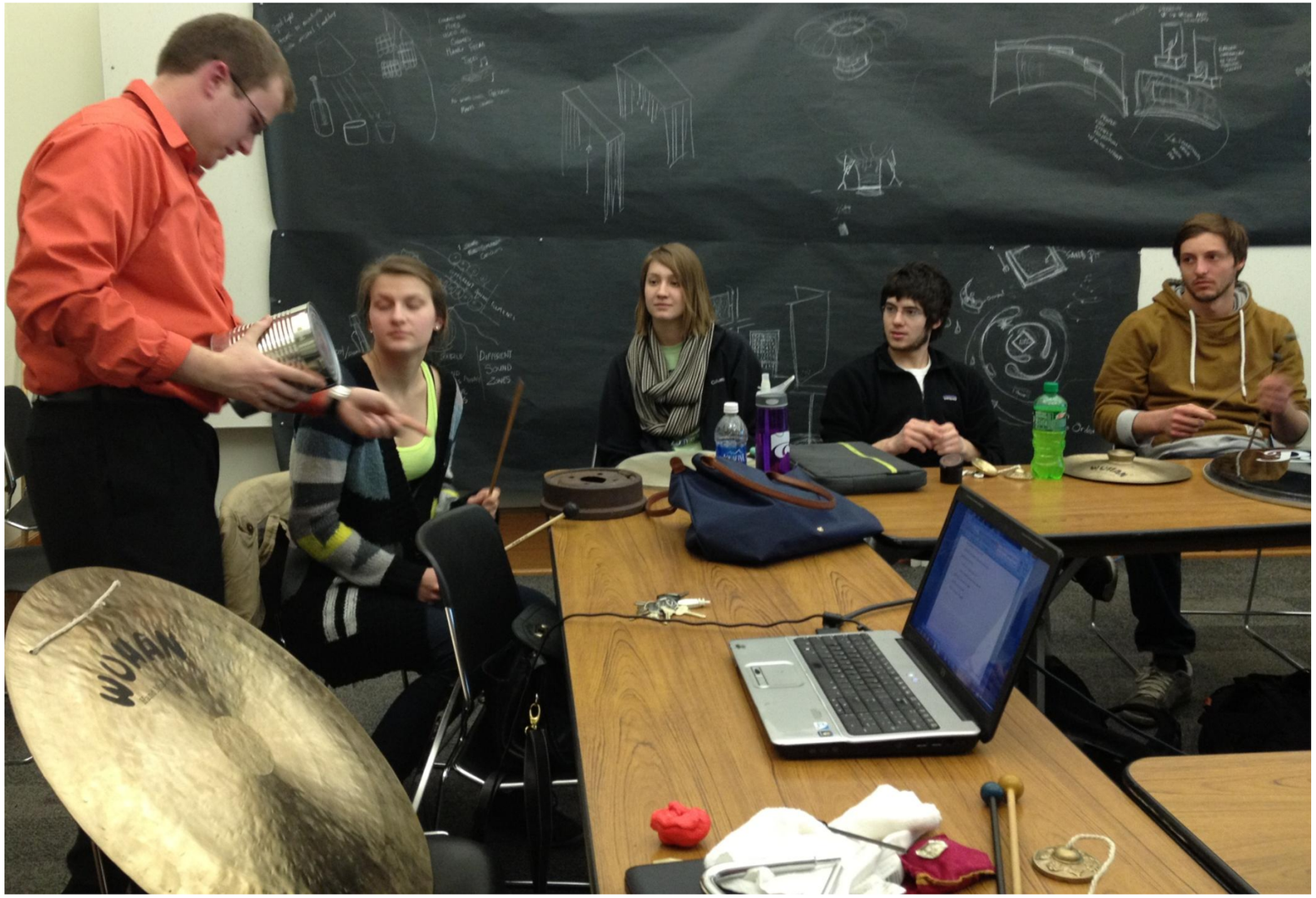






| Design of Sound Portals |

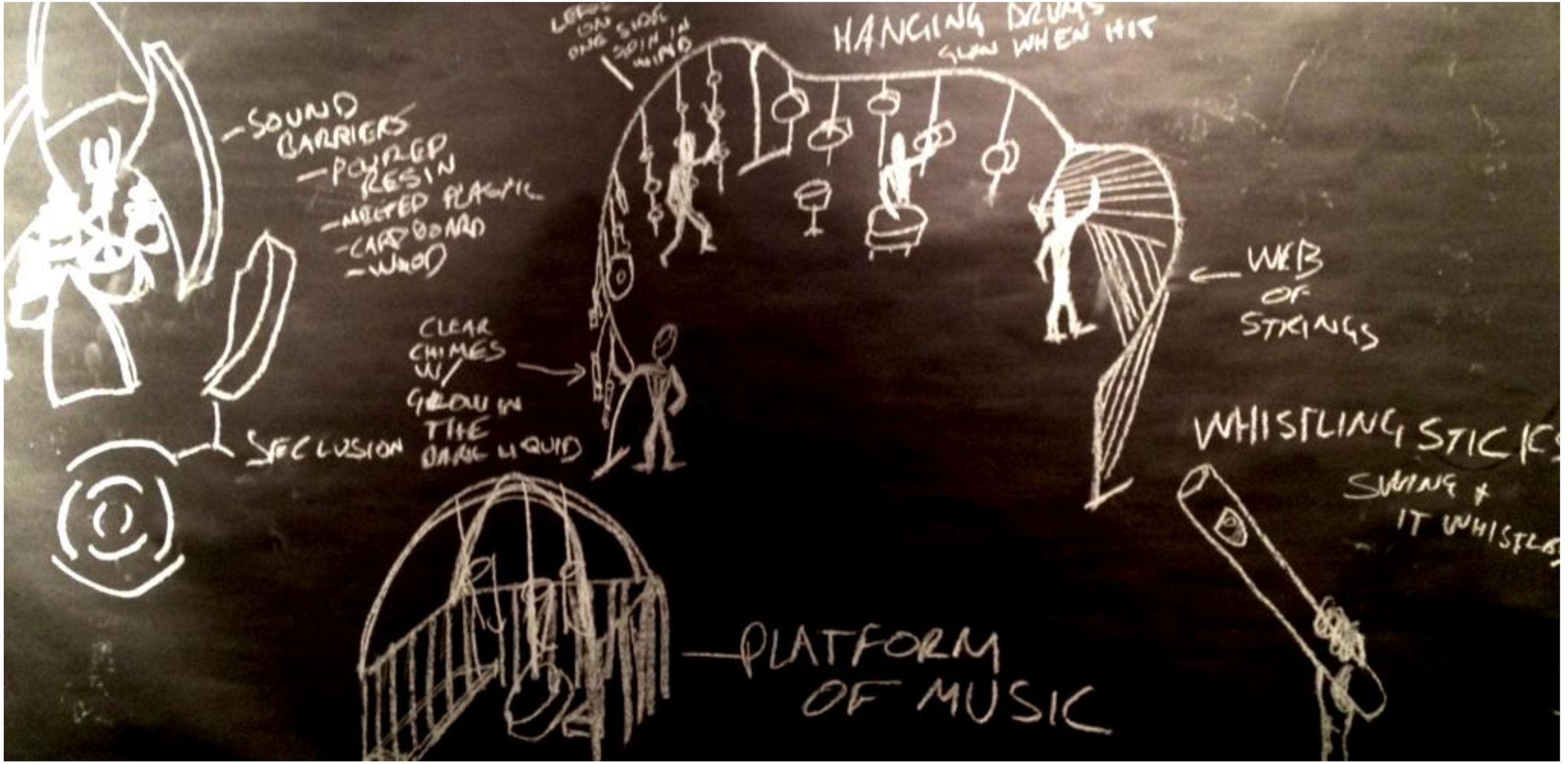
Music | Dance Department Collaboration





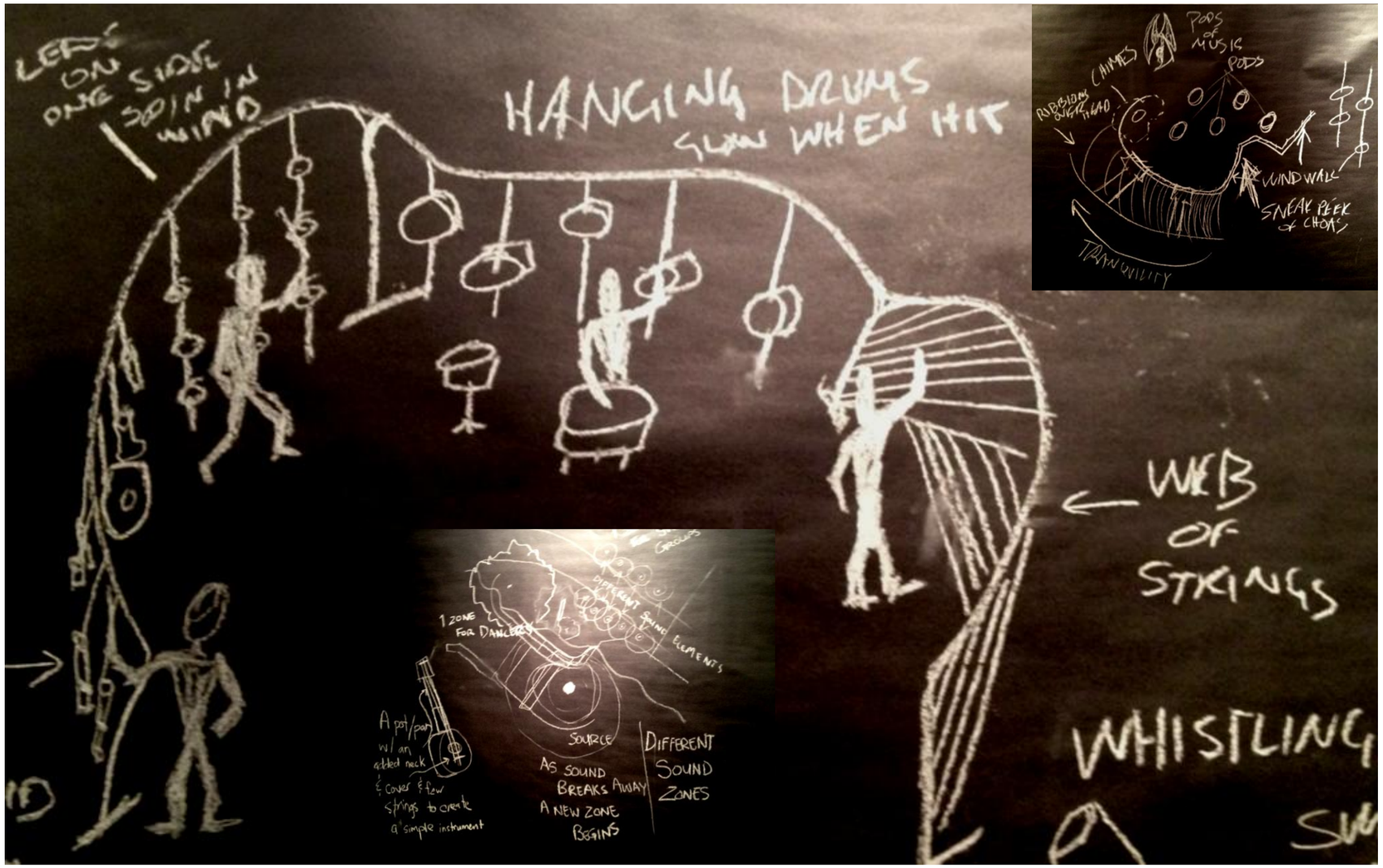


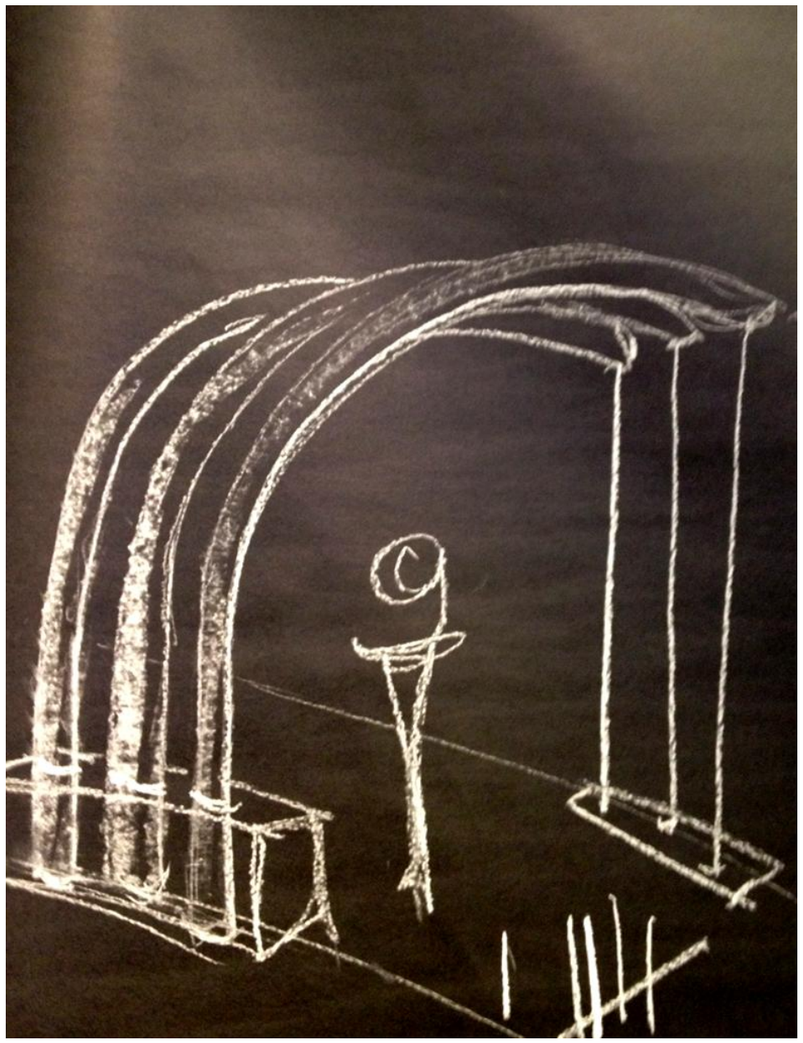
| Design of Sound Portals |



| Design of Sound Portals |

Inside - Outside | “Connection Piece” as an Engaging and Interactive Experience |

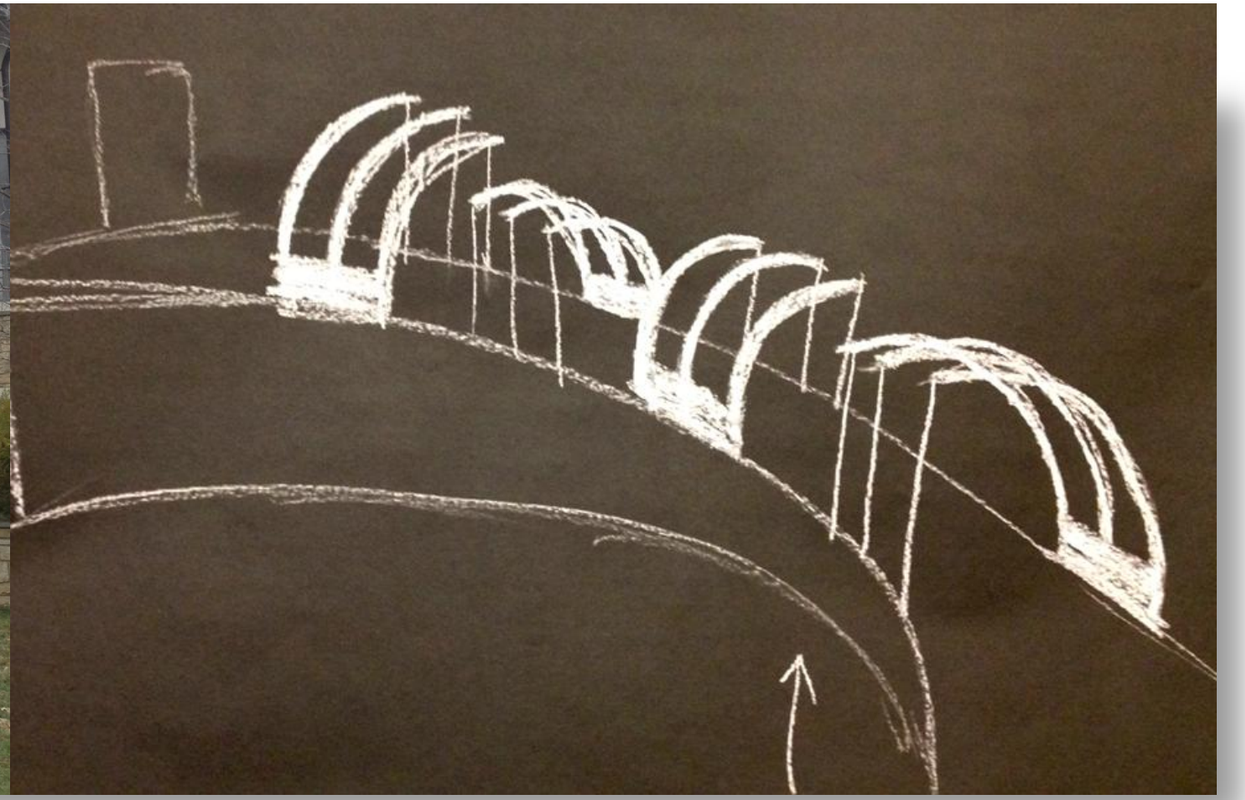




| Solution |

Inside - Outside | “Connection Piece” as an Engaging and Interactive Experience |

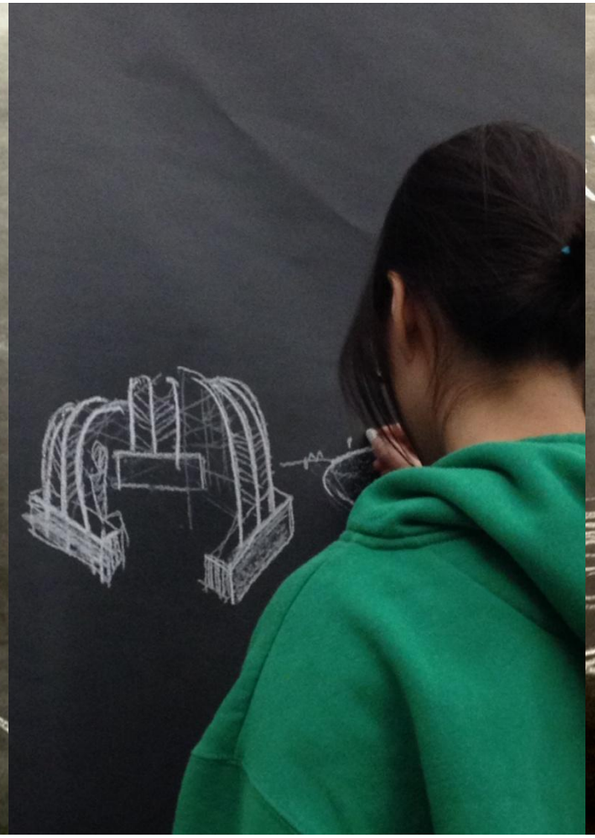


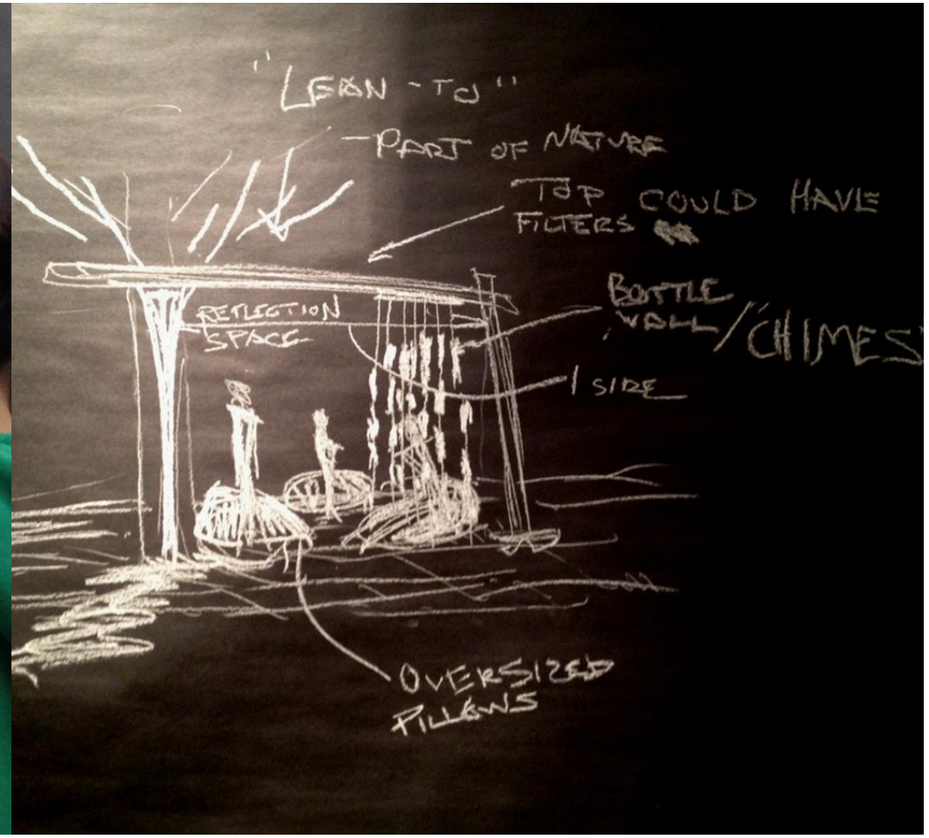


| Challenge |

| Art as Catalyst For Critical Thinking and Creative Discovery |
| Experiments in Sound and Lighting Design |

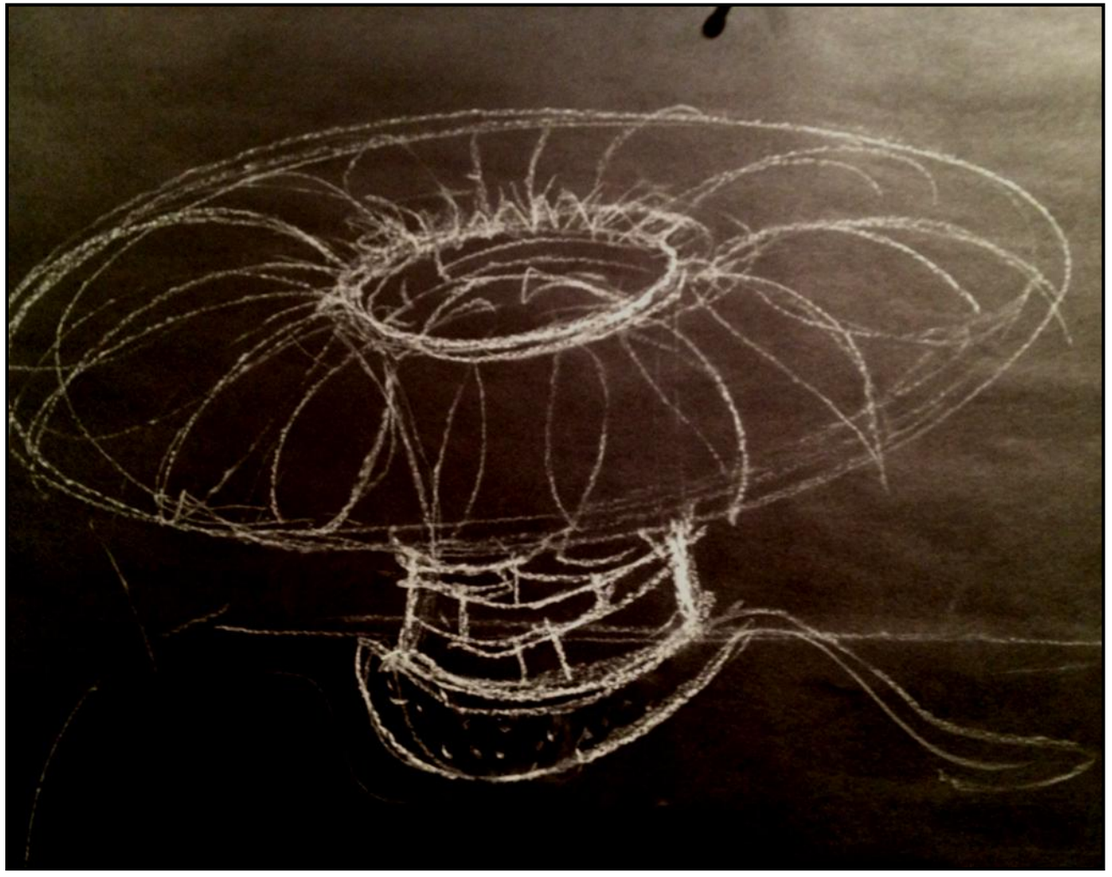


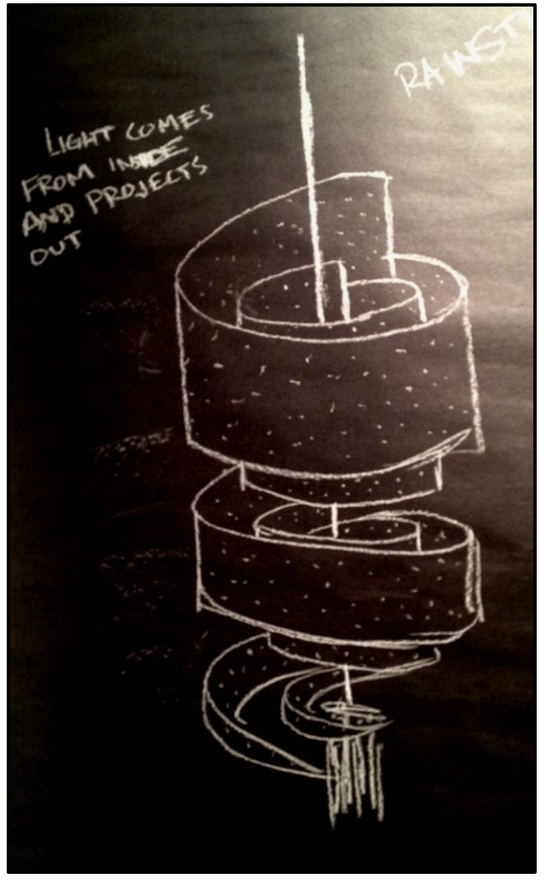


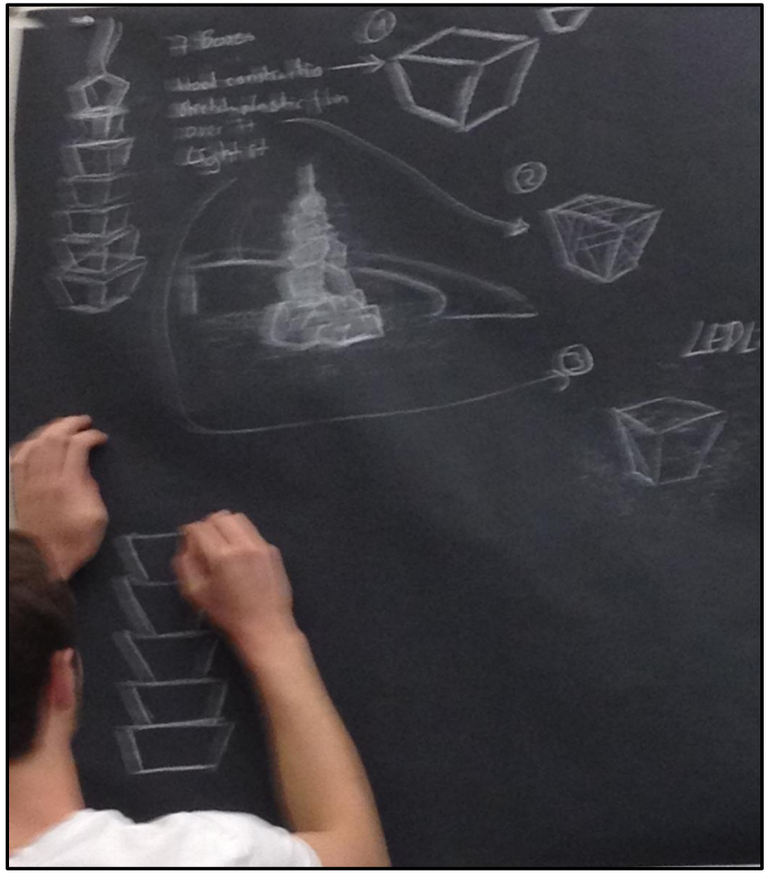


| Solution: Eternal Flame Sculpture |

| Art as Catalyst For Critical Thinking and Creative Discovery |
| Experiments in Sound and Lighting Design |







| Final Design |

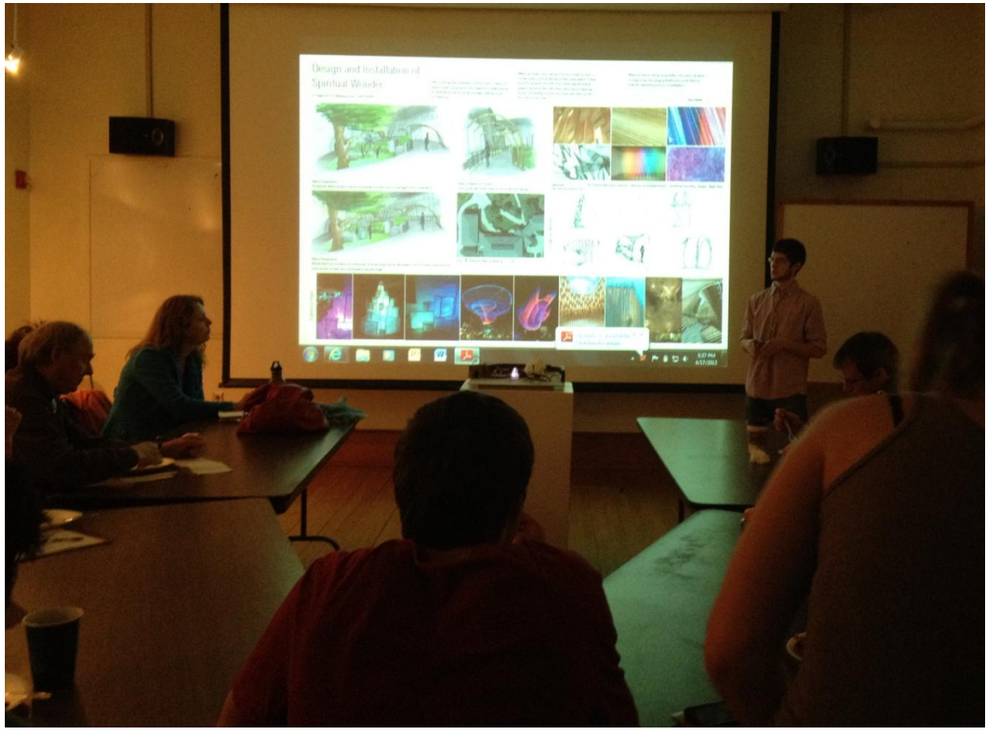


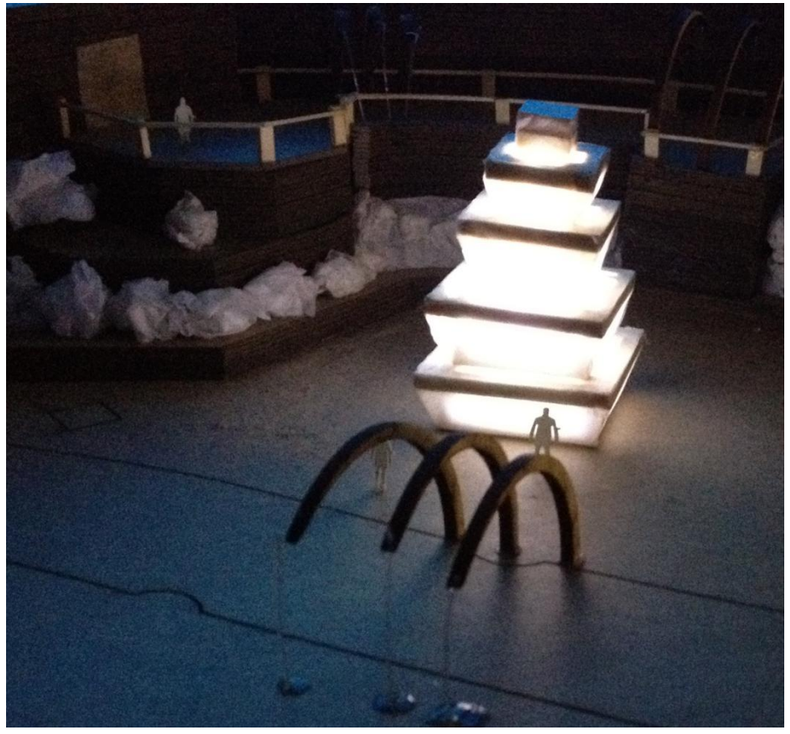
Eternal Flame!

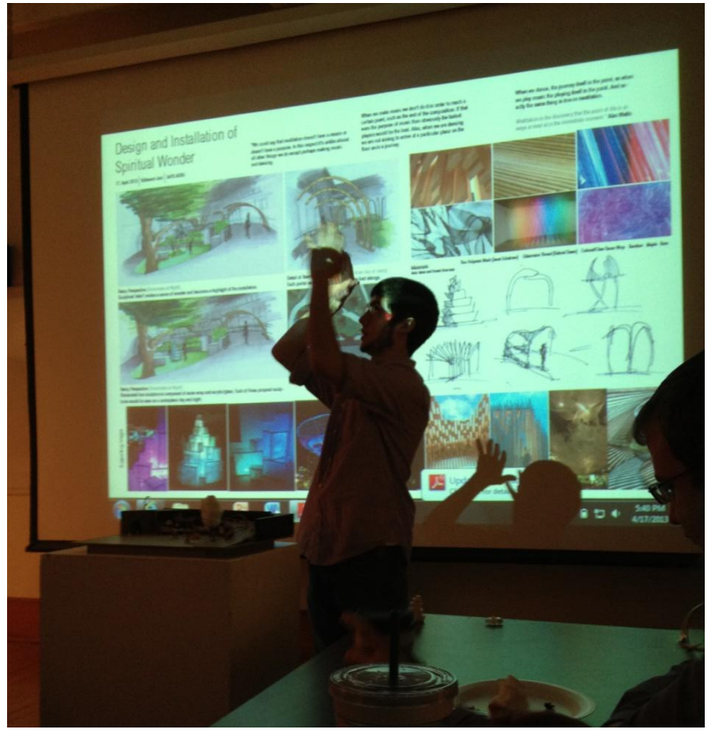


| Challenge |

Client Approval







| Debates |





| Challenge |

Construction of Portals | Eternal Flame Sculpture |





| Challenge |

Construction of Eternal Flame Sculpture | Installation













| Final Count Down |







| Technology |



CNC Routers
Laser Cutters
Projection
Laser Light
3D Printers
3D Scanners